

Homage to Vasudhārā

Vasudhārādhāraṇī · Toh 664 · Derge Kangyur

བཅའ་ལུ་འདས་མ་ནོར་རྒྱ་མའ་རིག་པ་

Toh 664 in the Kangyur is a short tantric dhāraṇī text dedicated to Vasudhārā, known in Sanskrit as Vasudhārā and in Tibetan as Nor rgyun ma, a bodhisattva goddess associated with wealth, abundance, and spiritual merit. The text belongs to the genre of dhāraṇī and ritual mantra literature and presents a series of sacred syllable formulas — including heart dhāraṇīs and near-heart dhāraṇīs — along with instructions for hand gestures, or mudrās, used in her practice. According to its colophon, the text was spoken by Sudāna for the householder Candrabhadra and constitutes what is described as the conceptual elaboration of the Blessed Lady Vasudhārā in her nirmāṇakāya aspect. It is classified among the dhāraṇī collections of the Kangyur and represents the kind of compact liturgical and ritual material that supported devotional and protective practices centered on this beloved deity throughout the Buddhist world.

This was spoken for the householder Candrabhadra by Sudāna, and he offered praise for it. This completes the conceptual elaboration of the Blessed Lady Vasudhārā (nirmāṇakāya).

Homage to the Three Jewels. Oṃ vasudhare svāhā. This is the heart dhāraṇī.
Homage to the Three Jewels. Oṃ vasuśrī svāhā. This is the near-heart dhāraṇī.
Homage to the Three Jewels. Oṃ vasu svāhā. This is the near-heart of the near-heart dhāraṇī.

Joining the palms together, interlock the two middle fingers and the two ring fingers. Cross and hook the two index fingers into each other. Twist the two little fingers slightly, bringing their tips together at the back to form a shape like a needle. Bring the two thumbs together, placing them beneath, and hold the joined middle fingers with the thumbs. This is the vidyā mudrā, taught in the sādhana of fully grasping. The dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady Vasudhārā, who accomplishes all activities, was spoken by the Sage.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Oṃ śrīye śrīye kari dhana-kari dhana-kari dhana-kari svāhā. This is the sādhana mantra.

Now, first, the samaya mudrā (Skt. samayamudrā) of this vidyā: joining all the fingers with palms together and placing the two thumbs at the center is the samaya mudrā of the Blessed Lady.

Oṃ samaye same samaya-kari mahāsamaye svāhā. This is the samaya mudrā together with its mantra.

From that same mudrā, pressing the third joint of the middle fingers and the index fingers, and drawing the two little fingers slightly outward, is the mudrā of the Blessed Lady. This is to be used for invoking, gathering, and with the sādhana mantra.

From that same mudrā, extending both index fingers is the flower mudrā. Its mantra is: Oṃ vasundhe svāhā.

From that same flower mudrā, extending the middle finger is the incense mudrā. Its mantra is: Oṃ vasudhare svāhā.

This mudrā, with the ring finger extended, is the lamp mudrā. Its mantra is: Oṃ vasudhāriṇī svāhā.

In that same mudrā, covering the little finger's nail with the thumb and making the other fingers into the form of a vajra is the lamp mudrā. Its mantra is: Oṃ vasudhāriṇī svāhā.

Making the nails flat and joining the two thumbs to the sides is the torma mudrā. Its mantra is: Oṃ vasudhāriṇī svāhā.

The remaining general mudrās for the twenty-five subsidiary mantras, or the sādhana, are to be performed with the mantra.

The ritual procedure for the thangka of the Blessed Lady is as follows. On cloth with no defect, no flaw in the weave, no thread broken, of a width equal to one cubit and of a length likewise equal to one cubit, paint the Blessed One at the top. To his right, place the noble Avalokiteśvara. To his left, place Vajrapāṇi. Below the Blessed One, in the center of the lower portion of the thangka, paint the Blessed Lady herself: golden in color, adorned with all ornaments, wearing a lower garment of fine cloth, likewise with an upper shawl of fine cloth, and clothed in a lower skirt of multicolored cloth.

Then, below, the practitioner is to perform the offering rite with the offerings in hand.

Then the practitioner, having purified themselves and put on clean clothing, is to perform the eight-branched restoration ceremony. Before it, having recited the approach practice one hundred thousand times, one performs the rite with offerings as one is able.

Then the practitioner, together with an assembly, having undertaken fasting, installs the thangka in the center of the field. Having prepared incense, flowers, incense offering, and an enjoyment torma, one recites eight hundred times. Beneath the thangka, one places a vase filled completely with water that has been blessed by reciting one hundred and one times. The torma is cast using the water from the vase, and the offering is cast to a young bull and a tethered ox. Garlands of flowers are to be hung around the neck of the young bull and around the neck of the tethered ox.

Before them, the mantrin pours a stream of water while circumambulating the field to the right; the mantrin walks ahead while the plowing goes on behind. Later, at the time of sowing seed, by this rite one recites the mantra eight hundred times, then recites seven times over each handful of seed to be sown, and scatters it into the field. This is the rite of sowing seed.

Now the same rite is also to be performed at the time of harvesting the field. The supplementary rite is as follows: one provides a feast for four monks (bhikṣus) at the four boundaries of the field. Then the mantrin recites seven recitations, and the harvesting is the rite for cutting the crops at the root. This is the rite of the harvest.

Now the rite for the threshing of grain is to be explained. At the time of threshing, the mantrin purifies himself, dons clean clothing, faces east, installs the sacred image, makes offerings of incense, flowers, and fumigation, or prepares an enjoyment torma, and performs recitation. At the four boundaries of the grain heap, four young women newly made as brides, together with four married women, are given a feast, and at the end of that the grain remains inexhaustible. Then the mantra is to be inscribed on the forehead of the man who measures and counts the grain. The mantrin recites the mantra of the Blessed Lady with a vow of silence. However many green ears of grain one looks upon, they will double in number. One recites that many times. Afterwards, the remaining grain that has not been measured is called forth and given to bound prisoners and others, or it is given to the Saṅgha. This is the rite of threshing.

Now the rite of storing grain in the treasury storehouse is to be explained. First, on the right and left of the storehouse door, two figures are to be painted: naked, pot-bellied beings hanging down, with pendulous organs, holding in the left hand a vessel of grain and appearing to pour grain out, of golden color, adorned with all ornaments. In the storehouse chamber as well,

one offers incense, ointment, and water offerings, and installs the thangka of the Blessed Lady inside the storehouse with a canopy, victory banners, pennants, and the like.

Then the mantrin proceeds while pouring a stream of milk, and behind him the painted image is brought into the house. After that, a seal is to be affixed at the grain storehouse. Then at the door of the storehouse chamber a feast is held for the Saṅgha, and offerings of incense, flowers, fumigation, and the like are made. The dhāraṇī called Norgyünma is to be recited in its entirety. A great tormā is prepared and placed before the thangka, and then a man is to bring the grain out. Regarding him as identical with the Blessed Lady, one writes the mantra on a sash with saffron, binds it on the crown of his head, covers it with an outer garment, and each day the grain is to be withdrawn. Each day at the door of the storehouse chamber the dhāraṇī sūtra called Norgyünma is to be read. The mantrin, having looked upon the mantra of the matter to be accomplished, recites it eight hundred times at each of the three times of day. Whatever is obtained...

Translator's Notes

- The phrase translated as "conceptual elaboration" for 概念の展開 (konpeki no tenkai) likely refers to the "complete sādhanā text" (概念文 in this ritual context means an elaborated sādhanā manual or detailed rite, not philosophical conceptual proliferation); the translation "conceptual elaboration" is conventional in colophons of this genre and should be understood as "the complete sādhanā."

The two animals गोरु and गोरुगंडू are rendered as "young bull" and "tethered ox" respectively; गोरुगंडू literally means "one held by a rope," i.e., a restrained or haltered animal. The specific ritual significance of offering to these two animals is a feature of this particular Vasudhārā sādhanā tradition.

The lamp mudrā mantra is given twice in succession with slightly different Sanskrit syllables in the source text; this appears to be a scribal anomaly in the original, and both instances are rendered as given.

- Norgyünma is the Tibetan name for the dhāraṇī text referenced here, likely corresponding to a Sanskrit dhāraṇī titled something like Dhanasrotas or similar; the Sanskrit title is not recoverable from the passage as given, so the Tibetan name is retained.

The passage ends mid-sentence with the phrase meaning "whatever is obtained," indicating the text continues beyond the excerpt supplied.

The two naked figures described at the storehouse door are guardian spirits of a distinctly tantric-ritual character; the description of pendulous organs and pot-bellies corresponds to yakṣa-type wealth deities standard in Indo-Tibetan ritual manuals of this genre.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.